

Day 4 — Space, the Quiet Friend

Module: Panchabhūta (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min

Goal

Children notice *ākāśa* — the element that has no shape, colour, or smell — by exploring empty space.

Materials

- An empty cardboard box, lid removed
- An empty cup
- A doorway or wide-open area
- Drawing paper

The flow

Settle + chant (5 min)

Daily chant. By now the chant should be fluid.

Story — recall (3 min)

“Who remembers all five friends?” — chorus. “Today: Ākāśa. She’s the quietest friend. She doesn’t have a shape. She doesn’t have a colour. But she’s the friend who lets everyone else exist.”

The Empty Box game (8 min)

- Hold up the cardboard box, lid off. *“What’s in this box?”*
- Children: *“Nothing!” “Air!”*
- *“You’re right that there’s air — but there’s also something else. The SPACE inside the box. The room. The gap. That’s Ākāśa.”*
- Pass the box around. Each child holds it and looks INSIDE the box. *“What do you see?”*
- *“Now look at this cup. The cup is Pṛthvī. The inside of the cup, where the tea will go — that’s Ākāśa.”*

Notice game (7 min)

- Children stand up.
- *“Hold your arms out. The gap between your arms — that’s Ākāśa.”*
- *“Look between you and the person next to you. That gap — that’s Ākāśa.”*
- *“Look up at the ceiling. The gap between your head and the ceiling — that’s Ākāśa.”*
- *“Ākāśa is everywhere there’s room for something else to be.”*

Sound demonstration (5 min)

- “*Ākāśa has one special thing — sound travels through it.*”
- Clap once, loudly. “*That clap travelled through Ākāśa to your ears.*”
- “*That’s why old Indian thinkers said Ākāśa’s quality is **sound** (śabda).*”

Draw (5 min)

Each child draws a place at home where they notice Ākāśa most. (The space under their bed? The empty room when no one’s there? The sky?)

Show + chant (2 min)

2 shares. Chant to close.

Homework

- Tomorrow we sing! Practise the chant at home with a parent or sibling.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Can you think of a place where there’s NO Ākāśa? (Trick question — even inside the densest rock, there’s a tiny bit of space between atoms. But that’s a Grade 6+ idea.)
- **Tier down:** Just remember: Ākāśa = the empty room where everything else lives.

Teacher’s quick notes

- This is the hardest day at this band — empty space is an abstract idea. The cardboard-box and arm-gap demos are essential.
- Some children will be confused: “but air is in the box too!” — that’s fine. “*Yes! Vāyu and Ākāśa are both there. They’re friends — they overlap a lot.*”